6.3 Off-chain data: External data sources

Off-chain data is stored on a variety of data sources, some of which are shown in figure 6.10. A significant difference from on-chain data is that the types and uses of off-chain data are not determined by the blockchain protocol; this data is used by the non-blockchain part of the larger system. Off-chain data can be anything from the output of a medical device to data in cloud storage. The types and formats of data sources are limitless and application-dependent. A typical scenario, however, is a regular database that works in tandem with the blockchain trust layer that is needed in a decentralized system of unknown peers.

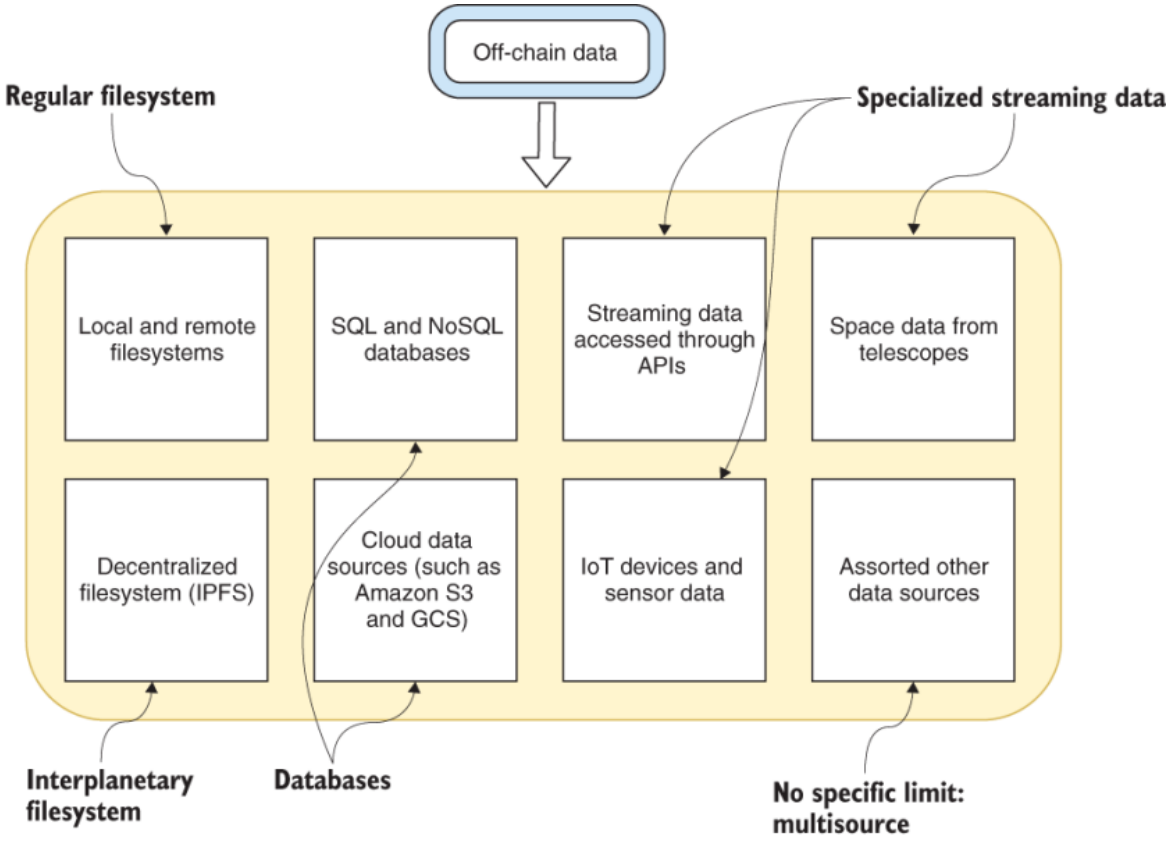


Figure 6.10 Different types of off-chain data